lamed him of one leg, by putting an issue into it. Our doctor Dr Bell and the Russian Dr Cadi have now made over their patient to a French doctor of the name of Cloqué newly arrived, who is to have three thousand tomauns a year pay besides his own private practice so he is in a fair way of making his fortune. Our doctor and the Russian are both rather annoyed and with reason. They brought the king round when he was at death's door and now they are superceded. It is true they are both physicians to missions and were called in because there was no other doctor here, but still they do not like being sent off in this way, altho they have been very well paid having made about a thousand pounds each.

Talking of doctors reminds me that there has been a most curious disease at Kashan or rather at a village near, which I do not know whether I mentioned in my last letter. The people are siezed with a violent head ache and go mad after a few hours.[104] Like all extraordinary things in Persia, the Persians must add the marvellous to it. And they say that one of its wonders is that, when the people have it, if they strike any one the person struck goes mad too. Some people were mentioning this in a room where I was and saying how extraordinary it was, "not at all" said a queer old fellow "our prime minister has had it many years, and has been beating all Persia!"

It was very stupid of me to write you of the kings dangerous illness, and then not tell you of his recovery. I keep no copies of my letters nor even a memorandum of what I write but must do the latter in the future. In cases of this kind, would not the people at the Foreign Office answer a question, as to whether the Shah was dead or not; I should think they would, if they were tried, for I am told they are civil. In fact it is civil of them forwarding our letters, which certainly forms no part of their duty.

You are right in supposing that it is my friend Layard[105] who is making the discoveries near Nineveh. I have not yet heard the particulars but they say they are most interesting. I hope it may be some thing substantial for him. He wants it poor fellow.

I walk about a good deal here, for a very good reason, I have no horse. The nightingales are in full song, the roses just beginning. I believe you have no yellow roses in England here they are in plenty both single and double, the double is a very fine tree growing sometimes eight feet high or even higher. The smell is not good. I am pretty sure we have some roses here which are not known in England and many different varieties of fruit. M' d'Ozeroff who I have mentioned to you, the Russian Consul Genl at Tabreez, has arrived here

104 Probably sunstroke. The town is known for its excessive heat during the summer.

105 Sir Henry Layard, the famous discoverer of the ruins at the site of Nineveh. Layard mentions Edward by name in his *Early adventures in Persia*, v. 1, p. 308 ff.

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